GitHub Repos & Communities — Where Pros Explore

> The actual places professionals go to stay sharp, find tools, and get inspired.
> Not random Google results — the sources themselves.

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Must-Star GitHub Repos

These are repos every serious JavaScript developer has starred. Not libraries to install — repos to *read, watch, and learn from.*

Your Stack — Official Repos

Repo	Why star it	GitHub
vercel/next.js	Watch for new features, read RFCs before they ship	github.com/vercel/next.js
shadcn-ui/ui	Read component source code — learn how pros write components	github.com/shadcn-ui/ui

Repo	Why star it	GitHub
tailwindlabs/tailwindcss	Understand what's coming, read the changelog	github.com/tailwindlabs/tailwindcss
pmndrs/zustand	Small codebase, beautifully written — great to read	github.com/pmndrs/zustand
colinhacks/zod	Understand how schema validation works under the hood	github.com/colinhacks/zod
prisma/prisma	Follow for database tooling updates	github.com/prisma/prisma
trpc/trpc	Worth understanding even if you don't use it	github.com/trpc/trpc
framer/motion	Read examples and the changelog	github.com/framer/motion

Learning & Reference

Repo	Why star it	GitHub
airbnb/javascript	The JavaScript style guide most companies follow	github.com/airbnb/javascript
ryanmcdermott/clean-code-javascript	Clean Code principles translated to JavaScript	github.com/ryanmcdermott/clean-code-javascript
trekhleb/javascript-algorithms	Algorithms and data structures — for interviews and fundamentals	github.com/trekhleb/javascript-algorithms
getify/You-Dont-Know-JS	The deepest free JavaScript book series	github.com/getify/You-Dont-Know-JS
leonardomso/33-js-concepts	33 concepts every JS developer should know	github.com/leonardomso/33-js-concepts
denysdovhan/wtfjs	Weird JS behaviour explained — fun and educational	github.com/denysdovhan/wtfjs

Repo	Why star it	GitHub
goldbergyoni/nodebestpractices	Node.js best practices — the most complete guide	github.com/goldbergyoni/nodebestpractices
typescript-cheatsheets/react	TypeScript + React patterns, exhaustive reference	github.com/typescript-cheatsheets/react

Tools & Utilities

Repo	Why star it	GitHub
tj/commander.js	Build CLI tools with Node.js	github.com/tj/commander.js
sindresorhus/awesome-nodejs	Curated Node.js packages — find anything	github.com/sindresorhus/awesome-nodejs
nicolo-ribaudo/tc39-proposals	Upcoming JavaScript language features	github.com/nicolo-ribaudo/tc39-proposals
tc39/proposals	Official upcoming JS proposals — see what's coming	github.com/tc39/proposals
microsoft/TypeScript	Follow for TypeScript language updates	github.com/microsoft/TypeScript

Awesome Lists

"Awesome" lists are community-maintained collections of the best resources in a category. Think of them as the internet's best curated directories.

List	What's in it	GitHub
awesome	The master list of all awesome lists	github.com/sindresorhus/awesome
awesome-react	Everything React — libraries, tools, tutorials	github.com/enaqx/awesome-react
awesome-nextjs	Everything Next.js	github.com/unicodeveloper/awesome-nextjs
awesome-nodejs	Everything Node.js	github.com/sindresorhus/awesome-nodejs
awesome-tailwindcss	Tailwind plugins, tools, templates	github.com/aniftyco/awesome-tailwindcss
awesome-typescript	TypeScript tools and resources	github.com/dzharii/awesome-typescript
awesome-shadcn-ui	Community shadcn components and extensions	github.com/birobirobiro/awesome-shadcn-ui
awesome-pwa	PWA resources, tools, examples	github.com/hemanth/awesome-pwa
awesome-framer	Framer Motion examples and resources	github.com/gromanek/awesome-framer
frontend-dev-bookmarks	Massive curated frontend resource list	github.com/dypsilon/frontend-dev-bookmarks
design-resources-for-developers	Fonts, colours, icons, UI kits — all free	github.com/bradtraversy/design-resources-for-developers
free-for-dev	Free tiers for every developer service	github.com/ripienaar/free-for-dev

> **free-for-dev** is one of the most useful repos on GitHub — it lists every service with a meaningful free tier. Check it before paying for anything.

Real Codebases to Read

The fastest way to level up is reading code written by people better than you. These are open source projects built with your exact stack.

Built with Next.js + shadcn + Tailwind

Project	What it is	GitHub
shadcn/taxonomy	The reference Next.js app — blog, dashboard, auth, billing	github.com/shadcn-ui/taxonomy
calcom/cal.com	Full scheduling platform — massive real-world Next.js codebase	github.com/calcom/cal.com
documenso/documenso	Open source DocuSign — Next.js + Prisma + shadcn	github.com/documenso/documenso
formbricks/formbricks	Open source Typeform — excellent Next.js architecture	github.com/formbricks/formbricks
openstatusHQ/openstatus	Status page and monitoring — clean Next.js + Tailwind	github.com/openstatusHQ/openstatus
dub/dub	Open source Bitly — Next.js + Prisma + Tailwind	github.com/dubinc/dub
twentyhq/twenty	Open source Salesforce CRM — advanced patterns	github.com/twentyhq/twenty
triggerdotdev/trigger.dev	Background jobs platform — read for architecture ideas	github.com/triggerdotdev/trigger.dev

Built with Node.js + Express

Project	What it is	GitHub
expressjs/express	Read Express source — surprisingly small and readable	github.com/expressjs/express
gothinkster/realworld	The same app built in every framework — compare approaches	github.com/gothinkster/realworld
nodejs/node	Node.js itself — intimidating but worth browsing	github.com/nodejs/node

> **How to read a codebase:** Don't read it top to bottom. Pick one feature you understand (e.g. auth, a form, a dashboard page) and trace just that feature from the UI to the database. That's more valuable than reading everything.

GitHub Trending

GitHub Trending shows what developers are building and starring right now. Check it weekly to stay aware of what's moving in the ecosystem.

```
github.com/trending                          → all languages, today
github.com/trending/javascript               → JS repos trending today
github.com/trending/typescript               → TS repos trending today
github.com/trending/javascript?since=weekly  → JS this week
github.com/trending/javascript?since=monthly → JS this month
```

What to look for:

- New tools in your stack (Next.js, Tailwind, shadcn ecosystem)
- Interesting UI libraries or animation tools
- Developer tools that save time
- New patterns or approaches people are excited about

What to ignore:

- Repos trending because of hype, not quality
- Things completely outside your stack
- Anything that would distract you from building

Communities & Forums

Where developers ask questions and discuss things

Community	Best for	URL
Stack Overflow	Specific technical questions with code	stackoverflow.com
Reddit r/webdev	General web dev discussion, career advice	reddit.com/r/webdev
Reddit r/reactjs	React-specific questions and news	reddit.com/r/reactjs
Reddit r/nextjs	Next.js questions and discussion	reddit.com/r/nextjs
Reddit r/node	Node.js discussion	reddit.com/r/node
Dev.to	Developer blogs and tutorials — write here too	dev.to
Hashnode	Developer blogging platform — good community	hashnode.com

Community	Best for	URL
GitHub Discussions	Most major repos have discussions — great for deep questions	github.com

How to ask good questions (saves hours)

```
1. Describe what you expected to happen
2. Describe what actually happened
3. Share the relevant code (minimal example)
4. Share the exact error message
5. Share what you've already tried

Do all 5 and you'll get answers in minutes.
Skip any of them and you'll wait hours or get ignored.
```

Newsletters

These land in your inbox weekly. Read them in 10 minutes. Stay aware without doomscrolling.

Newsletter	What it covers	Frequency	URL
Bytes	JavaScript news, funny and well-written	Weekly	bytes.dev
This Week in React	Everything React and Next.js	Weekly	thisweekinreact.com
Node Weekly	Node.js news and articles	Weekly	nodeweekly.com
JavaScript Weekly	Broad JavaScript ecosystem	Weekly	javascriptweekly.com
CSS Weekly	CSS techniques and tools	Weekly	css-weekly.com
Tailwind Weekly	Tailwind CSS news and resources	Weekly	tailwindweekly.com
TLDR Newsletter	Tech news in 5 minutes	Daily	tldr.tech
Changelog	Developer tools and open source news	Weekly	changelog.com

> **Don't subscribe to all of these at once.** Start with Bytes and This Week in React. Add others when you have a routine.

Twitter / X Accounts

The JS ecosystem moves fast on Twitter. These are the people who announce things first.

Core Framework People

Account	Who they are
@leeerob	Lee Robinson — VP at Vercel, Next.js thought leader
@shadcn	shadcn — creator of shadcn/ui
@timneutkens	Tim Neutkens — Next.js core team lead
@sebmarkbage	Sebastian Markbåge — React core team
@dan_abramov	Dan Abramov — React core (now at Bluesky)
@nicknisi	Nick Nisi — JS ecosystem, tooling

Educators & Community

Account	Who they are
@t3dotgg	Theo — opinionated takes on the modern JS stack
@joshwcomeau	Josh Comeau — best CSS and React educator
@wesbos	Wes Bos — practical JS and web dev
@kentcdodds	Kent C. Dodds — React testing and patterns
@fireship_dev	Fireship — fast-paced tutorials and news
@JackHerrington	Jack Herrington — deep React and Next.js
@mattpocockuk	Matt Pocock — TypeScript wizard
@kevin_powell	Kevin Powell — CSS mastery

Design + Dev

Account	Who they are
@steveschoger	Steve Schoger — Tailwind UI designer, visual design tips
@adamwathan	Adam Wathan — creator of Tailwind CSS
@samselikoff	Sam Selikoff — React and animation

Podcasts

For learning while not at a screen.

Podcast	Best for	URL
Syntax.fm	Practical web dev — Wes Bos and Scott Tolinski	syntax.fm
JS Party	JavaScript ecosystem news and discussion	changelog.com/jsparty
React Podcast	Deep React conversations	reactpodcast.com
The Changelog	Open source and developer tools	changelog.com
Soft Skills Engineering	Career advice for developers	softskills.audio
Full Stack Radio	Full stack web development	fullstackradio.com

> **Syntax.fm** is the one most Next.js developers listen to. Start there.

Discord Servers

Real-time help from real developers. Faster than Stack Overflow for specific questions.

Server	Best for	Invite
Reactiflux	React, Next.js, general JS — massive community	discord.gg/reactiflux
shadcn/ui	shadcn component questions, community showcase	discord.gg/shadcn
Tailwind CSS	Tailwind questions and community	discord.gg/tailwindcss
Prisma	Database and ORM questions	discord.gg/prisma
Supabase	Supabase-specific help	discord.gg/supabase
Vercel	Deployment and Next.js help	discord.gg/vercel
Theo's T3	create-t3-app, modern JS stack	discord.gg/t3gg
Kevin Powell	CSS help and community	discord.gg/kevinpowell

> **Reactiflux** is the most useful one — it has channels for every library you use and thousands of developers online at any time.

How to Use All of This

The biggest trap is spending more time reading about development than actually developing. Here's a routine that keeps you sharp without wasting time:

Daily (5–10 minutes)

```
→ Check your Discord servers for questions relevant to what you're building
→ If stuck on something, search Stack Overflow and GitHub Issues first
```

Weekly (20–30 minutes)

```
→ Read Bytes newsletter (bytes.dev) — stays fun, stays short
→ Read This Week in React — know what changed in your stack
→ Browse GitHub Trending (javascript, weekly) — spot new tools
→ Check awesome-shadcn-ui for new components you might use
```

When starting a new project

```
→ Check free-for-dev for any service you're about to pay for
→ Search awesome-nextjs for libraries relevant to what you're building
→ Check shadcn/ui Blocks for pre-built layouts
→ Browse Godly or Awwwards for design inspiration
```

When stuck on a bug

```
1. Read the error message carefully — most answers are in there
2. Check the official docs for the tool throwing the error
3. Search GitHub Issues for the repo — someone has had this before
4. Search Stack Overflow
5. Ask in the relevant Discord server with a proper code snippet
6. Then ask AI — by now you understand the problem better
```

When you want to improve

```
→ Pick one open source repo from the "Real Codebases" section
→ Find a feature you've built yourself
→ Read how they built the same thing
→ Notice what's different and why
```

Monthly (1 hour)

```
→ Star any repos you've been using but haven't starred
```

```
→ Unsubscribe from newsletters you're not reading
→ Update your patterns file with anything new you've learned
→ Add one pattern from a codebase you read this month
```

The Short List

If you only bookmark 10 things from this file, make it these:

```
1.  github.com/trending/javascript?since=weekly  — what's hot right now
2.  github.com/ripienaar/free-for-dev            — free tiers before paying
3.  github.com/shadcn-ui/taxonomy                — your stack, real project
4.  github.com/calcom/cal.com                    — massive real Next.js codebase
5.  github.com/goldbergyoni/nodebestpractices    — Node.js done right
6.  github.com/birobirobiro/awesome-shadcn-ui    — shadcn extensions
7.  github.com/bradtraversy/design-resources-for-developers — free design assets
8.  bytes.dev                                    — best JS newsletter
9.  discord.gg/reactiflux                        — fastest help
10. syntax.fm                                    — best podcast for your stack
```

The developers who grow fastest aren't the ones who read the most — they're the ones who build the most and know exactly where to look when they're stuck.